PLAYER 2 LEVEL UP · POLICY

STAFF CODE OF CONDUCT POLICY

POLICY OWNER	Rory Horseman, Owner, Player 2 Level Up
SAFEGUARDING LEAD	Rory Horseman
DATE ADOPTED	11 November 2026
NEXT REVIEW	11 November 2027

1. PURPOSE

Player 2 Level Up is committed to providing a safe, inclusive and supportive environment for children and young people participating in online gaming and mentoring sessions.

This Code of Conduct sets out the professional standards expected of everyone delivering services on behalf of the business, including the owner, employees, contractors and volunteers.

The welfare of children and young people is our priority, and everyone must act responsibly, respectfully and professionally.

2. PROFESSIONAL BEHAVIOUR

All staff and mentors must:

- Treat young people with kindness, dignity and respect.
- Recognise and respond appropriately to individual needs, including neurodivergence, disabilities and communication differences.
- Maintain appropriate professional boundaries.
- Use positive, supportive and non-judgemental communication.
- Avoid favouritism, discrimination, bullying or inappropriate language.
- Respect young people's privacy and confidentiality.
- Act as positive role models during gaming and mentoring sessions.

We recognise that young people may express emotions and communicate in different ways. Mentors should respond with patience, understanding and appropriate boundaries.

3. ONLINE COMMUNICATION AND BOUNDARIES

All communication with young people must be appropriate, transparent and related to the services provided.

Staff and mentors must:

- Use their Player 2 staff accounts, protected with two-step verification, and approved communication platforms.
- Avoid connecting with young people through personal social media accounts.
- Not share personal telephone numbers, addresses or private contact details.
- Avoid unauthorised communication outside agreed session times.

- Not send friend requests to young people on Discord or accept theirs, and not send them direct messages unless this has been agreed with parents or carers in advance.
- Not be alone on a call or in a voice channel with a young person, except during a booked One-2-One session, which is recorded.
- Never arrange secret meetings or private contact with young people.
- Never request inappropriate photographs, personal information or passwords.
- Not give or accept personal gifts or money without appropriate authorisation.

Any concerns about professional boundaries must be reported promptly.

4. CONDUCT DURING GAMING SESSIONS

Mentors must ensure gaming sessions remain safe, appropriate and supportive.

They are expected to:

- Follow the business's Age-Appropriate Games and Online Safety policies.
- Encourage respectful communication and positive interactions.
- Respond calmly to frustration, emotional distress or challenging behaviour.
- Avoid inappropriate jokes, threatening language or humiliating comments.
- Remain alert to bullying, grooming, exploitation or inappropriate online contact.
- Pause or end a session if necessary to protect a young person.

Mentors must not engage in inappropriate relationships, exploit their position of trust or behave in ways that could place a young person at risk.

5. SAFEGUARDING RESPONSIBILITIES

Everyone working on behalf of Player 2 Level Up has a responsibility to safeguard children and young people.

Staff must:

- Recognise and report safeguarding concerns promptly.
- Listen calmly and take disclosures seriously.
- Never promise to keep safeguarding concerns secret.
- Record concerns accurately and confidentially.
- Follow the Safeguarding and Child Protection Policy.
- Contact emergency services immediately if a child is in immediate danger.

Rory Horseman, as business owner and nominated safeguarding lead, is responsible for the business's safeguarding procedures.

Lorraine Payne, DSL at Willow Warwickshire Ltd, provides voluntary external safeguarding advice under a separate agreement. This does not transfer safeguarding responsibility to Willow Warwickshire Ltd or guarantee Lorraine's availability.

6. CONFIDENTIALITY AND DATA PROTECTION

Staff must protect all personal information relating to young people, families and colleagues.

Information must only be accessed, recorded or shared where necessary and lawful. Staff must follow the Data Protection Policy and use approved secure systems for records and communication.

Session recordings, the Discord activity log and AutoMod alerts must only be accessed for safeguarding and moderation. They must not be copied to personal devices or accounts, and must be deleted on time in line with the Data Protection Policy.

Safeguarding information may be shared with relevant professionals or authorities where necessary to protect a child.

7. REPORTING CONCERNS ABOUT STAFF CONDUCT

Any concern about inappropriate behaviour, professional boundaries or safeguarding practices must be taken seriously.

Concerns about staff or mentors should be reported to Rory Horseman.

Where a concern involves Rory Horseman himself, it should be reported directly to the appropriate Local Authority Designated Officer (LADO) or other relevant safeguarding authority.

Warwickshire LADO contact details:

Telephone: 01926 745376
Email: lado@warwickshire.gov.uk

Where the LADO referral threshold is met, the appropriate referral procedure must be followed promptly.

No person should face retaliation for raising a genuine safeguarding concern.

8. BREACHES OF THIS CODE

Any breach of this Code of Conduct will be taken seriously.

Depending on the circumstances, action may include additional guidance, supervision, restrictions on duties, disciplinary action or ending an individual's involvement with the business.

Where necessary, concerns will be referred to statutory safeguarding services or the police.

9. POLICY REVIEW

This policy will be reviewed annually or sooner if safeguarding guidance, working arrangements or business activities change.

It should be read alongside the Safeguarding and Child Protection, Online Safety, Behaviour, Safer Recruitment and Data Protection policies.

Approved by Rory Horseman, Owner, Player 2 Level Up, on 11 November 2026. Next review due 11 November 2027.